

Multi-Feature Search-Based Purchasing Tendency Community Classification for Densely Distributed Clients in E-Commerce

Base Paper Details

Title: Machine Learning in E-Commerce: Trends, Applications, and Future Challenges

Authors: Elias Dritsas, Maria Trigka

Year:2025

Publication: IEEE Access, Volume 13

Research Scope: Reviews machine learning methods used in e-commerce for personalization, fraud detection, pricing, and customer behavior analysis.

Findings: ML improves efficiency and personalization in e-commerce, but issues like scalability, privacy, and interpretability remain key challenges.

Problems Faced

Many e-commerce systems rely on rule-based or basic recommendation methods that fail to capture complex customer purchasing relationships.

Businesses often lack clear insights into location-wise demand patterns, leading to inefficient inventory and pricing decisions.

Existing platforms struggle to identify purchasing communities accurately, reducing the effectiveness of personalization strategies.

Traditional models do not effectively learn changing customer behavior over time, limiting their ability to predict future demand.

The absence of integrated customer and seller intelligence reduces marketplace efficiency and weakens strategic decision-making.

Aim and Objective

Aim

The aim of the project is to develop a deep learning-based framework that classifies customer purchasing tendency communities and predicts location-wise demand to improve personalization and strategic decision-making in e-commerce.

Objectives

- To analyze demographic and behavioral purchasing data from e-commerce customers.
- To model customer-product-location relationships using Graph Neural Networks.
- To capture temporal buying patterns using a Transformer-based SASRec model.
- To classify customers into purchasing tendency communities.
- To identify high-, emerging-, and low-demand geographic regions.
- To generate personalized product recommendations for users.

Abstract

This project proposes a deep learning framework to classify purchasing tendency communities in e-commerce platforms. It uses Graph Neural Networks to model relationships among customers, products, and locations, and a Transformer-based SASRec model to capture temporal buying behavior. The system identifies regional demand patterns and delivers personalized recommendations, helping sellers make better inventory and pricing decisions. Overall, it improves marketplace efficiency and personalization.

Introduction

Overview: E-commerce platforms struggle to understand complex customer purchasing patterns using traditional rule-based or basic recommendation systems.

Motivation: Businesses require smarter tools to identify purchasing communities and regional demand trends for better personalization and planning.

Objective: To develop a deep learning framework that classifies purchasing tendency communities and analyzes location-wise demand using GNN and Transformer models.

Outcome: The system improves personalization, demand prediction, and strategic decision-making for sellers.

Existing System

- **Rule-Based Recommendation Systems**

Many e-commerce platforms rely on predefined rules to suggest products based on basic customer actions.

- **Collaborative Filtering Models**

Traditional systems use collaborative filtering to recommend products by comparing user similarity.

- **Basic Customer Segmentation**

Customers are grouped using demographic or transaction-based clustering methods.

- **Static Demand Forecasting Models**

Existing systems estimate product demand using historical sales data and focus on past trends without deeply modeling dynamic customer behavior.

Drawbacks

- Cannot model complex customer–product–location relationships effectively.
- Fails to capture temporal changes in purchasing behavior.
- Produces weak personalization for densely distributed users.
- Struggles with sparse or incomplete transaction data.
- Limited ability to detect emerging or shifting demand regions.
- Basic clustering ignores deep behavioral patterns.
- Static models cannot adapt quickly to real-time market changes.

Proposed System

The proposed system uses deep learning to classify purchasing tendency communities and improve personalization in e-commerce. It combines graph modeling and sequential learning to understand customer behavior, product demand, and location patterns dynamically.

- **Graph-Based Community Modeling (GNN)**

Customers, products, and locations are modeled as a graph and analyzed using a Graph Neural Network. This algorithm discovers hidden relationships and classifies purchasing communities while identifying region-wise demand patterns

- **Sequential Preference Learning (SASRec)**

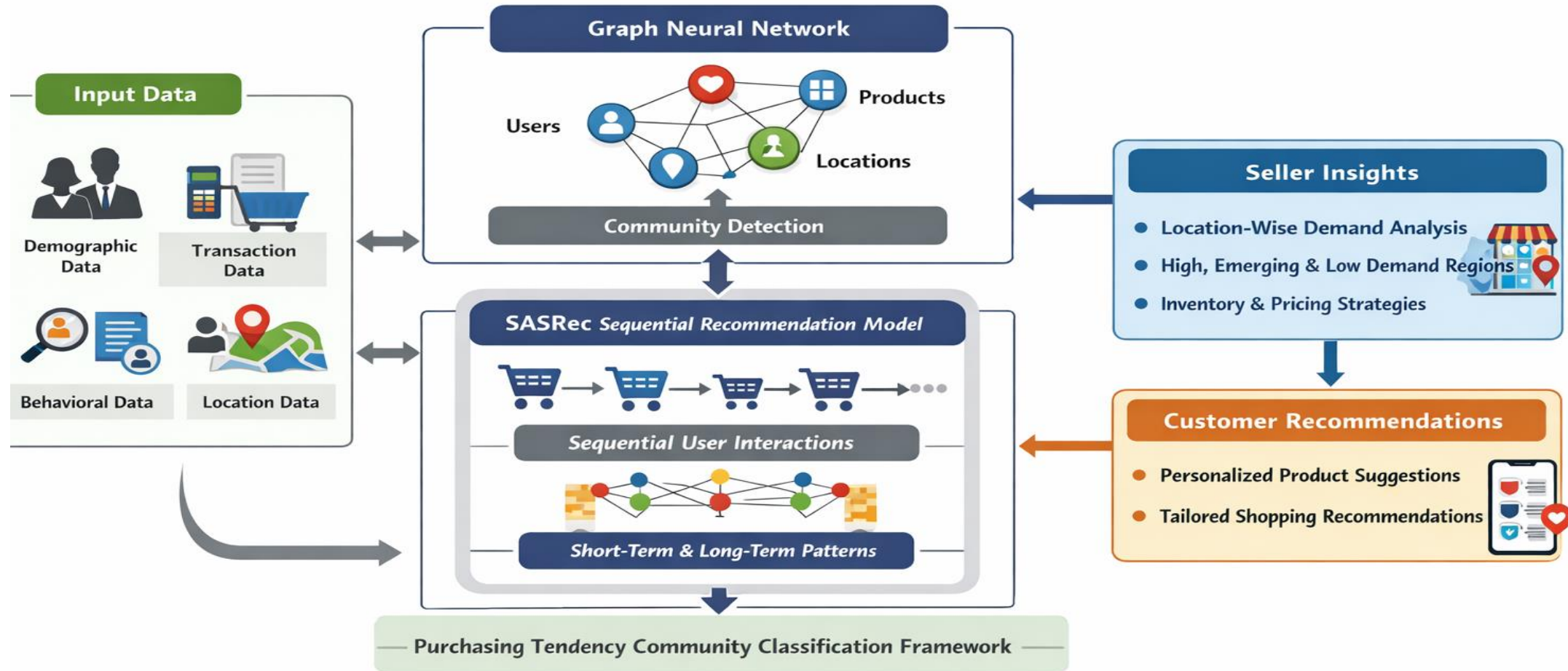
A Transformer-based SASRec model studies customer purchase sequences to capture changing preferences over time. It generates accurate personalized recommendations by learning short-term and long-term behavior.

Advantages

- Improves accuracy of product recommendations for customers.
- Helps businesses understand regional demand trends clearly.
- Supports smarter inventory and pricing decisions.
- Enhances customer satisfaction through personalization.
- Reduces marketing waste by targeting the right audience.
- Increases sales efficiency and marketplace performance.
- Enables data-driven decision-making for sellers.

System Architecture

Multi-Feature Search-Based Purchasing Tendency Community Classification for Densely Distributed Clients in E-Commerce



Modules

- 1.E-Commerce Web App
- 2.End User
- 3.Model Training
- 4.Purchasing Tendency Community
5. Sequential Behavior
6. Demand Insight
7. Recommendation
8. Visualization
9. Notification
10. Reports

1.E-Commerce Web App

This module forms the foundation of the system and is developed using Python, Flask, MySQL, Bootstrap, Wamp Server, and supporting libraries. It provides the web interface through which admins and users interact with the platform. The module manages user registration, authentication, energy data monitoring, and system activity logging. All smart-meter readings and user interactions are stored in the MySQL database, which acts as the primary data source for model analysis. The responsive Bootstrap interface ensures easy access across devices, while Flask APIs connect the front end with backend analytics and machine learning components.

2.End User

2.1 Admin

The Admin manages the overall system and supervises platform activities. This role handles user registrations, monitors system operations, and ensures proper data flow between the web application and analytical models. The Admin also manages datasets, initiates model training, and reviews system reports and logs.

2.2 Seller

The Seller manages product listings, updates pricing, and monitors sales performance. Through the dashboard, the Seller can view demand patterns and purchasing trends. These insights help the Seller plan inventory distribution and promotional strategies.

2.3 Buyer

The Buyer interacts with the system by browsing products, searching items, adding them to the cart, and making purchases. Buyer actions such as views, clicks, and purchases are recorded and used to improve recommendation accuracy and demand analysis.

3.1 TendGraphNet Build & Train

3.1.1 Graph Data Preparation

Customer, product, and location data are transformed into graph format. Nodes represent customers, products, and geographic locations. Edges represent interactions such as views, cart additions, and purchases.

3.1.2 Feature Encoding

Demographic, transaction, behavioral, and purchase pattern features are encoded into numerical representations and attached to corresponding nodes and edges.

3.1.3 Graph Construction

A heterogeneous graph is constructed capturing multi-entity relationships across the e-commerce network.

3.1 TendGraphNet Build & Train

3.1.4 Graph Embedding Learning (GNN Training)

The GNN performs message passing across connected nodes to learn embeddings that capture similarity in purchasing behavior and regional demand influence.

3.1.5 Embedding Storage for Inference

Learned embeddings are stored and later used by the recommendation and analytics modules.

3.2 SeqBehNet – Build & Train

3.2.1 Sequence Data Preparation

Customer purchase histories are arranged in time order to form sequences of product interactions.

3.2.2 Sequence Encoding

Products in sequences are converted into embeddings, and positional encoding is applied to preserve order information.

3.2.3 Self-Attention Learning (SASRec Training)

The SASRec model uses self-attention to learn relationships between past and recent purchases, capturing short-term and long-term preferences.

4. Purchasing Tendency Community Discovery

This module identifies and forms purchasing tendency communities using embeddings generated by the TendGraphNet model. Instead of analyzing customers individually, it groups customers with similar product interests, purchasing behavior, and geographic characteristics. These communities help understand collective buying patterns across products and regions. The system also performs product association analysis to identify which products are preferred by each community. Additionally, it maps community behavior with locations to determine areas with high, moderate, or low demand.

5.Sequential Behavior

This module identifies and forms purchasing tendency communities using embeddings generated by the TendGraphNet model. Instead of analyzing customers individually, it groups customers with similar product interests, purchasing behavior, and geographic characteristics. These communities help understand collective buying patterns across products and regions. The system also performs product association analysis to identify which products are preferred by each community. Additionally, it maps community behavior with locations to determine areas with high, moderate, or low demand.

6. Demand Insight

This module converts the outputs of **TendGraphNet** and **SeqBehNet** into practical demand insights for sellers. It analyzes community behavior to identify which customer groups drive demand for specific products. The system also maps demand across geographic regions to classify areas with high, moderate, or low demand. Time-based analysis is performed to understand how product demand changes across seasons and sales periods. These insights help sellers plan inventory, promotions, and regional marketing strategies effectively.

7. Recommendation

The Recommendation Module provides personalized product suggestions by combining insights from TendGraphNet and SeqBehNet. It identifies the customer's purchasing community and analyzes their purchase sequence to understand current interests. By combining these insights, the system generates relevant and time-aware recommendations. The suggestions are continuously updated based on new user interactions. These recommendations are displayed on the buyer's dashboard to improve engagement and purchasing experience.

8. Visualization

The Visualization Module converts analytical outputs into easy-to-understand graphical dashboards. It displays insights through charts, graphs, and visual indicators instead of raw data. Visuals include community distribution charts, product popularity graphs, and geographic demand heatmaps. These dashboards help admins and sellers quickly understand trends and make informed decisions.

8. Visualization

The Visualization Module converts analytical outputs into easy-to-understand graphical dashboards. It displays insights through charts, graphs, and visual indicators instead of raw data. Visuals include community distribution charts, product popularity graphs, and geographic demand heatmaps. These dashboards help admins and sellers quickly understand trends and make informed decisions.

9. Notification

The Notification Module sends timely alerts based on system activity and analytics. Buyers receive notifications such as personalized product recommendations, price drops, and restock alerts. Sellers receive alerts about trending products, demand changes, and low stock levels. These notifications help users take quick and informed actions.

10. Reports

The Reports Module generates structured reports summarizing system analytics and demand insights. Reports include community behavior, product-wise demand, regional trends, and recommendation performance. Admins and sellers can download these reports for analysis and record keeping. This helps in planning marketing strategies, inventory management, and business decisions.

References

1. **J. Chen, J. Zhou, and L. Ma**, “GNNCL: A Graph Neural Network Recommendation Model Based on Contrastive Learning,” *Neural Processing Letters*, vol. 56, art. no. 45, Feb. 2024.
2. **X. He**, “Graph Neural Networks in Recommender Systems,” *Applied and Computational Engineering*, vol. 79, pp. 234–240, Jul. 2024.
3. **C. Li, Y. Cao, Y. Zhu, et al.**, “Ripple Knowledge Graph Convolutional Networks for Recommendation Systems,” *Machine Intelligence Research*, pp. 481–494, Jan. 2024.
4. **R. Luo, X. Chen, and Z. Ding**, “SeqUDA-Rec: Sequential User Behavior Enhanced Recommendation via Global Unsupervised Data Augmentation,” *Economics and Management Innovation*, 2024.
5. **C. Ezeife and H. Karlapalepu**, “A Survey of Sequential Pattern Based E-Commerce Recommendation Systems,” *Algorithms*, vol. 16, no. 10, p. 467, Oct. 2023.